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Dream Machine - Creative AI News and Insights

DREAM MACHINE | Creative AI News & Insight { May 2026 - Issue 27 }



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Creative Technologist & R&D Director | Working across
innovation in Film, Games, Music, Experiences, Interactiv...



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Welcome to edition 27 of DREAM MACHINE.

Keeping an eye on developments, debates, news and tools across **AI in the Creative Industries**: covering Film, Music, Games, Media & Entertainment.

Created and curated by **DreamLab**, a studio of artists, creative technologists, directors, games & software developers based in the UK..... including Emmy winners, PhD researchers, and BAFTA-recognised creative talent working at the cutting edge of creative technology.

You can also listen to this newsletter as a **podcast** 🎧



Dream Machine | Creative AI Newsletter

Creative AI News

Film, TV, Broadcast & Animation

- ComfyUI hits \$500M valuation as creators seek more control over AI-generated media [LINK](#)
- Cannes AI film festival raises eyebrows – and questions about future [LINK](#)
- Three Years Ago Today, "Avengers" Director Joe Russo Predicted There Would Be a Fully AI-Generated Movie Within Two Years. How'd that work out? [LINK](#)
- Freepik is now Magnific [LINK](#)
- Chinese Netflix Competitor Opens Floodgates to AI Slop [LINK](#)
- South Korea's first AI film hits theaters. But is it watchable? [LINK](#)
- Runway API Hackathon begins next week. One weekend. Free API credits. \$25,000 in prizes. [LINK](#)
- Kling AI Unveils Industry-first Native 4K Mode to Support Cinematic-Level Output [LINK](#)

Games, Immersive & Interactive

- Unity AI is in Open Beta [LINK](#)
- 'Their favourite games were already built with AI': Google exec says almost every big studio uses AI, but not all disclose it [LINK](#)
- Anthropic join the Blender Development Fund as Corporate Patron [LINK](#)
- Google claims 90 percent of developers use AI to create games but are not telling players [LINK](#)
- AI is going to change the video game industry. Morgan Stanley says these 4 stocks will be winners [LINK](#)

Spotify + Anthropic

Music & Sound

- Spotify Brings Music and Podcast Recommendations to Claude [LINK](#)
- "Everyone is using these tools, artists at all levels – but they don't want to talk about it": How AI is changing electronic music [LINK](#)
- ElevenMusic, a new platform to discover, remix, create, and earn from music, built on the ElevenLabs music model. [LINK](#)
- Music Platform Korin AI is 'trained with African datasets, built by Africans' [LINK](#)
- Spotify co-CEOs talk ad challenges and plans for GenAI features [LINK](#)
- Suno recruitment ad points to more music-industry dealmaking [LINK](#)

- Taylor Swift files to trademark voice and image after AI concerns [LINK](#)
- Taylor Swift's Trademark Move Exposes a Legal Gap: Who Is Liable for AI Voices That Were Never Copied? [LINK](#)
- Apple says AI music is rising, but streams remain low [LINK](#)

Other Media & AI News

- Apply for the ComfyStudio Artist Residency [LINK](#)
- UK government should clarify whether it's investing in AI companies that use unlicensed training data, say campaigners [LINK](#)
- TikTok is letting users remix videos with AI—what creators need to know [LINK](#)
- New AI-Powered Robot Can Destroy Human Champions at Ping Pong [LINK](#)
- Google plans to invest up to US\$40 billion in Anthropic [LINK](#)
- WPP Rethinks Consumer Journeys With Google Earth AI Integration [LINK](#)



Tool & Technique Spotlight

VISTA4D

- "Vista4D," developed by Netflix and Eyleline. It reconstructs live-action footage as 4D point clouds and uses video generation AI to fill in the gaps. [LINK](#)

M-XR's Foundation PBR Model

- M-XR's foundational PBR model, capable of applying PBR textures to any 3D asset. Input a clean 3D mesh and get six PBR maps back: albedo, diffuse, roughness, metallic, specular, and IOR - at 4K. [LINK](#)

Bytedance's Seed3d 2.0

- ByteDance has released Seed3D 2.0, a model capable of generating 3D objects from a single image or a text prompt. [LINK](#)
- Pixel3DMM: Versatile Screen-Space Priors for Single-Image 3D Face Reconstruction [LINK](#)

Autorigging in Autodesk Flow Studio

- Autodesk Introduces AI Rigging and Neural Layer in Flow Studio. [LINK](#)
- Insanely Fast Whisper can transcribe 2.5 hours of audio in 98 seconds. Open Source and Local [LINK](#)

Echo-2

- Echo-2, the newest model from [SpAltial AI](#) was just announced. In addition to generating worlds, it also decomposes them. [LINK](#)
- Someone categorized every FFmpeg command you'll ever need into one cheatsheet built specifically for video automation pipelines. [LINK](#)

Cesium

- 3D Gaussian splats are now available in the Cesium and 3D Tiles ecosystems, including CesiumJS, Cesium for Unreal, and Cesium ion. [LINK](#)
- Microsoft VibeVoice: Open-Source Frontier Voice AI [LINK](#)
- How to prompt 20 second videos locally with LTX 2.3 [LINK](#)

Reallusion Headshot 3

- Reallusion Headshot 3 has released - for digital double creation [LINK](#).

- Google's M2SVid turns any 2D video into immersive 3D - End2End monocular-to-stereo video conversion [LINK](#)
- smol-audio - A collection of notebooks & scripts to build on cutting-edge local audio models [LINK](#)
- Claude can now be plugged into Ableton to assist with your music projects [LINK](#)
- Google Introducers Veo 3.1 Lite, now available via the Gemini API and Google AI Studio. Veo 3.1 Lite supports both Text-to-Video and Image-to-Video, and is less than half the cost of Veo 3.1 Fast. [LINK](#)

Next Time...

You got to the very end, we hope you found this edition helpful.

If you've got any recommendations, opportunities or news we need to know about for our next edition please feel free to reach out to [Pete Woodbridge](#) 🙌

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